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[00:13:25] House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:13:42] The members will rise and be led in prayer by Dr. Rabbi Dr. Israel Zoberman, spiritual leader Tempo Lev Tifka, Church of the Holy Apostles, Virginia Beach, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:13:59] dear delegates, dear friends, Adonai, our shared one God of the essential commandments of loving kindness, who is the source of all life, spiritual and physical, bring us together to be one caring family, gratefully united and gloriously diverse in our enchanting commonwealth of Virginia, proud home of the 1786 Virginia Statue of Religious Freedom, drafted by Thomas Jefferson and passed by this Auguste General Assembly that also honored me on my 50th anniversary as an

[00:14:37] ordained rabbi. These are unsettling and challenging times of rising hateful extremism and the resurgence of noxious anti-Semitism, which is the world's oldest and most resistant deadly virus. As myself, a member of the Holocaust surviving remnant of European Jewry, Having lost most of my Polish family, I can attest to what happens when humans are deprived of their birthright and citizenship.

[00:15:16] And democracy soon turns into the subversion of all that we hold dear. It happens quickly, my friends.

[00:15:26] On this Virginia Jewish Lobby Day, may we all reconnect and recommit to turn pain into compassion, and compassion into passion, and passion into promise, division into vision, and blemishes into blessings, ensuring that America's unique lights of freedoms, rights, and responsibilities ever shine brightly for the sake of the entire human family.

[00:16:01] Let us ever insist that our precious Virginia is only for lovers, with Shalom's divine agenda of healing, hope, and harmony for all of God's children. And let us say amen and God bless. Amen.

[00:16:23] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:17:11] We'll close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the Journal of the House of Delegates for February 9th, 2026. Motions and resolutions of the Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications?

[00:17:27] No announcements or communications. Therefore, pursuant to House Rule 40 in this first portion of the morning hour, speak a request that you use your request to speak button for the agenda item solicited for reference up on the voting board. The Delegate for Middlesex, Delegate Hodges. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the house, today's invocation was generously provided by Rabbi Israel Zoberman.

[00:17:51] Rabbi Zoberman was born in Kazakhstan to Polish Holocaust survivors and has devoted more than five decades to faith and to service, which our body and the body down the hall recognized in a joint committing resolution two years ago.

[00:18:11] He is the founding rabbi of Congregation Beth Shavarim in Temple Lev Tikva and is widely recognized as a respected civic and spiritual leader throughout Hampton Roads.

[00:18:27] He made history as the first rabbi to earn a doctorate of ministry degree from a Cormac Theological Seminary, reflecting a lifelong commitment to interfaith understanding. We are pleased to welcome him today and welcome him to the Capitol and appreciate his invocation to the House.

[00:18:51] So, Mr. Speaker and ladies and gentlemen of the House, please join me in giving Rabbi Zoberman a warm House welcome.

[00:19:11] Welcome, Rabbi Zoberman, and thank you for that lovely invocation this morning. The delegate from Prince William, Delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of a motion and an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that on that House Bill 318 on page 56 of the first reading regular calendar be referred to the House Committee on Appropriations.

[00:19:37] Doug, for Prince William, Delegate Turing moves that HB 318 be re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations. Delegate from, oh, your motion, I'm sorry, your introduction.

[00:19:53] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the House joining us in the House Gallery today are members of the Prince William County in Northern Virginia and Richmond Metropolitan Area Chapters of the National Coalition of 100 Black Women. I would ask them to stand, please.

[00:20:08] The National Coalition of 100 Black Women is a non-profit volunteer organization dedicated to uplifting the voices of black women and girls through advocacy, education, and collaboration.

[00:20:24] The NCBW chapters of Virginia collectively seek to promote leadership and gender equity in the areas of health, education, and economic empowerment. Mr. Speaker, I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to give these lovely women a warm house welcome.

[00:20:40] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegates from Suchis County, Delegate Waxman.

[00:20:57] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'll rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, it's my pleasure today to introduce the group from Brunswick County who came today. If you could please rise. I do hope by now that you realize that this team is part of the large team that's been outside the General Assembly building today, that they have been toiling away, doing their craft and making their stew for us here at the General Assembly as well as our staff.

[00:21:26] They got here extremely early this morning, Mr. Speaker. In the wee earlies of the morning, our stew master, Kevin Pear, came down with his family and they started bringing the pot. I got there about 7 o'clock. It was already done. This is the 24th year that these people have done this tradition and served us driving up from the beautiful county of Brunswick County.

[00:21:48] Mr. Speaker, I had a presentation I was going to say about this group, but a picture I saw came up to me. It was, I was standing by the stew pot earlier today, along with Senator Jordan, who I share Brunswick County with. The governor was there at the pot, and you, sir, were doing something that people told me you do so well.

[00:22:08] You were there stirring the pot for us today. But it really was a beautiful picture when my legislative director gave it to me, and it made me stop in awe at that photo.

[00:22:26] you can see it on my Facebook account, but instantly I realized that these individuals have done something that few have done. They pulled four of us together from across the aisle to sit there and enjoy Brunswick stew. I'd like to say that I think that we need to have more Brunswick stews here at the Capitol to pull people together. It's my pleasure to introduce these people today, and I do wish that everybody would give my friends a nice warm house welcome.

[00:23:08] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. And y'all just got all these bills killed, by the way. No, just joking, just joking. Sorry, not sorry. The delegate from here, right go. Delegate McQuinn. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an announcement. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I want to announce the Sickle Cell Caucus Meeting Reception that is hosted by Senator Lucas, Senator Locke, Delegate Brianna Sewell, Cliff Hayes, and Delegate Margaret Franken, and yours truly, on Thursday, February

[00:23:47] the 12th, 2026, from 8 a.m. to 9.30 a.m. in House Subcommittee Room 9. We have special presenters who will be there, VCU Health System, Sickle Cell Association of Virginia, Centero, Facts, and many others.

[00:24:02] And so we ask that you would please join us again as we advance this agenda and making certain that all of us is informed as much as possible to go back to our various community and help them out. So thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Fowler.

[00:24:20] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an announcement. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. We're at that time where we want to talk about Feed More. And this is something that we do every year, Mr. Speaker, you know, to raise money, feed more, and they provide foods for all around Central Virginia.

[00:24:42] And so I think, you know, we've got boxes all around the General Assembly building. But you know what's a lot easier, Mr. Speaker, I think, if everybody just write a check, you know, to feed more. And, you know, I look in the building here, here on the floor, and I see just a small bunch of us and a whole lot of y'all.

[00:25:06] And I'm just wondering, I don't think we all have a contest and all, but, you know, I think we can probably raise more money than y'all can. So, anyway, look at him. He must then pay attention to the last campaign.

[00:25:23] Let's have some fun. And, again, hopefully everybody will help out and support FEMA. Mr. Speaker, thank you. I love you. The delegate from Rasul, delegate, I mean, the delegate from Roanoke City, delegate Rasul.

[00:25:40] You got me. I'm going to get you. We can do it all today, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of two introductions. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, ladies in the House. First, I'd like to welcome Arc of Virginia, if Arc of Virginia could please stand. The ARC of Virginia has held together 21 different chapters all across Virginia for more than 70 years, advocating for those with developmental disabilities and a wide range of support needs.

[00:26:07] ARC advocates for comprehensive person-centered services, real opportunity, and community-based supports. We had several of them in my office today talking about the need to make sure we're taking care of those who are taking care of others.

[00:26:22] And these leaders today are some champions who are facing some tough times with the federal cuts that are coming down, but are here to do some great work for us. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to give them a warm house welcome. Welcome.

[00:26:43] Welcome to the Capitol today. Mr. Speaker. Oh, you have another thing. Yes, Mr. Speaker. Delegate for one note. Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise with the purpose of another introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I today want to also introduce and recognize 211 Virginia.

[00:27:01] If they could please rise. You've heard of 9-1-1, but when you've got some questions, you can call 2-1-1 in Virginia, Mr. Speaker. 2-1-1 is a statewide human service system mandated by the Code of Virginia and the Virginia Department of Social Services.

[00:27:19] This was created years ago by then-Governor Cain. Since 2006, 2-1-1 Virginia, when people have questions about how to access services in their community, their comprehensive database and the work that they do, no matter where you are in Virginia, you can call on them. 2.3 million Virginians have requested help from 2-1-1 as they navigate their life challenges. I hope that we can give them a warm house welcome.

[00:27:54] Okay, you're done. Okay. The delegate from Warren County, Delegate Oaks. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that H.R. 85 on page

83 of the calendar be passed by until Friday, February 13th.

[00:28:14] Delegate from Warren County, Delegate Oates, moves that H.R. 85 found on page 83 be passed by until February 13th. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. It's passed by until February 13th. Suing to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business and are granted leave from today's session, Delegates Bennett Parker and Delegate Knight.

[00:28:37] The clerk will announce the next order of business. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, second portion of the morning hours are for the announcement of member requests legislation from any uncontested calendar over to a regular calendar. There are five. That first category, House Bill's third reading uncontested, page one, House Bill 22, Delegate Helmers, out of the block over to the regular calendar.

[00:28:55] Same category going forward in the calendar to page 9, Delegate Watts' House Bill 958 out of the block over the regular calendar. The former by Delegate Tran, the latter by Delegate Wright. Clerk will announce the next order.

[00:29:12] Oh, I'm sorry. I'm just going ahead. And the next big block of uncontested second, page 28, Delegate Herrings, House Bill 898 out of the block to the regular. The request of Delegate Wyatt, page 30, second reading uncontested, Delegate Hernandez's, House Bill 1062, out of the block, the request of Delegate Griffin.

[00:29:36] And going ahead to page 33, Delegate Shins, House Bill 1225, out of the block, over to the regular calendar, the request of Delegate Griffin again. The clerk will announce the next order. Third portion of the morning hours are for member requests for legislation to go by for the day. I don't have any such motion by the Majority Leader.

[00:29:52] There are three of which I'm aware, all in the category of second reading regular. Second reading regular, page 37, Delegate Trans, House Bill 1161, buy for the day, and Delegate McClure, same page, House Bill 524.

[00:30:08] Both of those are the request of Delegate Trans. And then on page 42, same category, Delegate Bennett Parker's, House Bill 975. that is bye for the day. Delegate Trans request as well. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation as announced by the clerk go bye for the day. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation as announced by the clerk go bye for the day. As many in favor of the motion, say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to.

[00:30:34] Clerk will announce the next order. And in the fourth and final portion of the morning, our speaker requests to use your request to speak button for points of personal privilege to get into the queue. Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Woke. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for request. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we go back to the first morning hour with the purpose of an introduction.

[00:30:52] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. And ladies and gentlemen of the House, I'd hoped, I held off as long as I could. I hoped they'd make it into the gallery. But today with us on the Capitol grounds are some members of the Legislative Affairs Committee from James Madison University.

[00:31:08] They're Student Government Association. They're led by their chair, Caroline Sperling. And I ask that you would join me in giving them a warm house welcome. I'm sorry. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Guzman.

[00:31:30] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today, I would like to recognize and commend the four athletes from Prince William County competing in the 2026 Winter Olympics in Italy.

[00:31:48] Sarah Everhart, Ilya Malinin, Evan Nichols, and Mystic Roe have all worked tremendously hard to represent the U.S. and the Commonwealth with excellence, discipline, and pride. All former students of the Prince William School System, their dedication reflects countless hours of training, sacrifice, and perseverance.

[00:32:12] And their achievements serve as an inspiration to young athletes across Virginia and the nation. Sarah Everhart was a graduate of Battlefield High School in 2025 and was named an alternate for the U.S. Women's Figure Skating Team.

[00:32:29] She earned a bronze medal at the 2025 US Figure Skating Championship and trains at the Washington Figure Skating Club. Evan Nichols, a resident of Haymarket, was also a Battlefield High School alumnus and is representing Team USA in sled hockey.

[00:32:47] He won gold at the 2022 Paralympic Games in Beijing and is returning for his second appearance in 2026. Mystic Roe was a constituent and a graduate from Brentsville High School.

[00:33:03] Well, she resided for 11 years in Knoxville. She's competing in the skeleton event. She worked through incredible odds as one of the only black athletes at Brentsville High School in track and field. Roe has earned both silver and gold medals on the skeleton World Cup circuit and made history as the first American to win a skeleton race in eight years.

[00:33:28] Ilya Malinin attended Penn Elementary School in Prince William County, Dell City, and is competing in figure skating. A child of Russian immigrants, both of his parents were national skating champions at Uzbekistan, and he's currently the reigning world champion.

[00:33:49] He also won gold in the team event this past Sunday. As athletes compete on the world stage, Mr. Speaker, we celebrate not only their athletic talent, but also the values of hard work and sportsmanship they embody.

[00:34:06] I ask my colleagues to join me in congratulating these outstanding Virginians and wishing them the very best as they represent Virginia and the United States at the 2026 Winter Olympic Games, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore.

[00:34:35] Mr. Speaker, return to the first morning hour for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, and I'm not sure they've made it up in the gallery yet, but in the gallery or waiting to get in the gallery, we have students from the University of Virginia's college at Wise who made this six-hour drive up to the Capitol to advocate and learn about civics in action.

[00:34:57] And, Mr. Speaker, UVA Wise is a vital part of Southwest Virginia and stands as the only four-year public institution west of Blacksburg. And, Mr. Speaker, finally, it's continued to provide an affordable, high-quality education for over 70 years. And on behalf of the Southwest delegation, I ask that we give them a warm welcome to the House of Delegates.

[00:35:20] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Hanover, Delegate White. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for introduction.

[00:35:36] Can we turn to the first morning hour, please? Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today, we have members from the Leadership Hanover visiting the Capitol. I, too, think they're still in line waiting to get into the gallery. But Leadership Hanover is a nine-month professional and leadership development academy put on by the Hanover Chamber of Commerce Foundation.

[00:35:56] This year's group includes 16 professionals, each representing a different industry, company, organization. Members of Leadership Hanover participate in monthly sessions focused on leadership philosophy, self-awareness, effective communication, delegation, teamwork, long-range planning, and effective networking, as well as citizen civic engagement.

[00:36:20] The class learns from an accomplished and varied faculty from across Hanover, Henrico, and the Richmond region, and today they're spending their time at the Capitol visiting with legislators. They are directed by a steering team comprised of area business owners. Would the members of the House please join me in giving these folks from Leadership Hanover a warm House welcome?

[00:36:43] Thank you. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol Gate. The Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask for us to move to the first morning hours for the purpose of an introduction.

[00:37:01] The Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I have two introductions and a motion. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise in honor to present the Van Lefcoe Leadership Development Course from Portsmouth, Virginia, and I ask that they would please stand.

[00:37:18] Mr. Speaker, members of the House, this Portsmouth-based nonprofit founded in 1996 to cultivate informed, engaged, and ethical leaders in our community. This three-month program honors the legacy of the Van Lefkoe, a lifelong Portsmouth resident whose commitment to public service continues to inspire generations.

[00:37:45] Through 12 weeks of discussion, learning, and direct engagement with local, state, and federal government, participants gained firsthand insight into how leadership truly works. Mr. Speaker, with more than 600 graduates serving on boards, commissions, and in public office, the Lefcoe Leadership Program continues to strengthen Portsmouth and the Commonwealth through principal civic leadership.

[00:38:13] Please extend to them a warm house welcome.

[00:38:25] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol. They were like in uniform. They were like, I'm like, loosen up. Y'all are a little stiff up there. Y'all tight. Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Mr. Speaker. I have to apologize in advance.

[00:38:42] Mr. Speaker, give me one more chance. Give me, give me one more chance. Mr. Speaker, all around the world, in every hemisphere, there's a common refrain that no matter where you are, if you happen to hear, behold, that refrain, Mr. Speaker, echoes from the land of Sparta on the campus of Norfolk State University to all around

[00:39:22] the globe. Mr. Speaker, visiting with us today are students from the Norfolk State University accompanied by members of the administration and faculty, including our president of the university, President Dr. Javon Adams Gaston, better known as Dr. J.

[00:39:42] They are visiting the Capitol today for their annual Day on the Hill. These students are spending the day meeting with our officers, sharing their personal experiences, and getting a first-hand look at the work that takes place here at the General Assembly during session.

[00:39:58] As a proud alum of Norfolk State University, I, along with Delegate Fagans, as well as you, Mr. Speaker, are excited to see NSU community in Richmond supporting policies and strengthening institutional sustainability, expand student access and affordability, as well as support workforce development, social and economic mobility across the Commonwealth.

[00:40:22] I ask, Mr. Speaker, members of the House, if you would extend to them a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Welcome to the Capitol.

[00:40:42] The delegate from Chesapeake, you have another motion, correct? A motion. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I've asked for the purpose of a motion, and I would like to speak to that motion. Delegate, has the floor. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I've conferred with my dear friend, Delegate McQuinn.

[00:41:01] She, too, enjoyed a personal relationship with King Selene Calfani, who has now joined the ancestors. As John Doe once wrote, never sin to know for whom the bell tolls.

[00:41:21] It tolls for thee. That's the what, Mr. Speaker. And as Terence, a poet, a former slave, and in 156 B.C. wrote, homosum humani eme nelium a puto, which simply means in Latin and English, that I am a human being, Mr. Speaker, and there's nothing human that is alien to me.

[00:41:56] Mr. Speaker, like Terrence, King Selene always fought for humanity and the causes of those least able to help themselves. And in that spirit, Mr. Speaker, we reflect on his life.

[00:42:17] I first met Selene in 1988 when I was a student of Norfolk State University, and he was at Virginia Union. We reconnected in 1995 when I was appointed to the Virginia State Conference of the NAACP board and he was an assistant executive director. As the assistant executive director of the Virginia NAACP, he fought for justice, unconscious bias, training, criminal justice reform, dash cams in our police cars, dismantling the

[00:42:53] school-to-prison pipeline, voting rights, access to quality affordable health care, and ensuring access to the ballot box for all. He stood for public education funding, better pay for educators, and access to health care in every corner of the Commonwealth.

[00:43:16] A proud member, Mr. Speaker, of Omega Psi Phi Fraternity Incorporated Zeta Chapter at Virginia Union in 1981. He now has joined Omega Chapter. His legacy of equity and justice endures.

[00:43:38] Equally, his commitment to manhood, scholarship, perseverance, and uplift were always evident. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, I move that when the House adjourns today, it does so in the honor and memory of King Salim Calfani.

[00:44:04] The delegate from Chesapeake, Doug Goodhays, moves that when the House adjourns today, it do so in the honor and memory of King Salim Calfani. All those who are in favor of the motion shall rise. The motion is agreed to.

[00:44:24] The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise and ask that we return to the morning hour for another introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery, we have individuals.

[00:44:41] They're a lobby day for the Virginia Fentanyl and Substance Awareness Organization. Would they please rise? This organization is here to raise awareness about fentanyl poisoning, crisis, and share real family stories as they advocate for prevention, education, accountability, and policies to protect our community.

[00:45:02] This Virginia-based organization founded by families that were directly infected, and their focus, main focus, is to save lives moving forward. Their work ensures fentanyl-related deaths are treated as a public health and safety emergency, not just a statistic.

[00:45:19] Mr. Speaker, nearly 2,000 Virginias died of fentanyl overdose in 2022. In 2024, that number was reduced to 1,400. That's a 43% improvement.

[00:45:34] Mr. Speaker, I want to thank these individuals as they continue to engage with lawmakers and continue to raise the awareness of the harm fentanyl is doing to our communities. So I want to thank them, and on behalf of this organization, and I would ask that the members of the House please give them a warm House welcome.

[00:46:07] The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Simons. Mr. Speaker, I request we return to the first morning hour for an announcement. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an announcement. I know we just enjoyed Brunswick stew today, but we're in luck.

[00:46:26] We have another delicious lunch tomorrow. The James River Association will be providing blue catfish tacos starting at 10:30 a.m. in Darden Garden. Blue catfish are an invasive species that consume tons of our native seafood and damaged water quality in the James River and the Chesapeake Bay.

[00:46:46] The best way to combat these invasive fish is to catch them and eat them. So I invite everyone to join me for blue catfish tacos on the way to Caucus tomorrow. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Orange County, Delegate Hamilton.

[00:47:03] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we return to the first portion of the morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today I rise to recognize the parents, students, heads of private and faith-based schools, and concerned citizens who have traveled from across the Commonwealth for Don't Tread on Parents Day, sponsored by the Family Foundation of Virginia.

[00:47:24] For more than 40 years, the Family Foundation has defended a principle that this body has already affirmed in law and that our courts have repeatedly upheld that parents have the fundamental right to the upbringing, education, and care of their children. The families and school leaders in the gallery today are here because that right is being challenged.

[00:47:46] They are responding to legislative proposals and the repeated blocking of common sense protections that undermine parental authority, threaten the independence of private and faith-based schools, and leaves students without basic privacy safeguards. They are here to defend parental involvement in education, student privacy in bathrooms and locker rooms, and the freedom of families to choose educational setting that best serves their children.

[00:48:12] Their message is clear. Parental rights and educational freedom are not optional and will not be trampled in silence. Please join me in welcoming the parents, school leaders, and citizens here today

for Don't Tread on Parents Day. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Anthony.

[00:48:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. For Black History Month today, we recognize Norfolk State University, an HBCU, proudly located in my district. And I want to honor a giant whose legacy continues to shape our community, our culture, and our commonwealth, Dr. Emory L. Fiers.

[00:49:04] Dr. Fears, affectionately known as Chief, was the founding architect of the Norfolk State University's Spartan Legion Marketing Band. From 1974 to 1991, he did not simply direct a band.

[00:49:20] He built a standard, a standard of excellence, discipline, and pride that continues to define Norfolk State University today. Though born in Tuskegee, Alabama, Dr. Fears made Virginia his life's work, shaping generations of students and institutions across this commonwealth.

[00:49:41] Before his tenure at NSU, he led outstanding music programs in Virginia's public schools, including I.C. Norcom High School, where his bands earned 18 consecutive superior ratings and national recognition.

[00:49:59] And wherever he served, he built people as intentionally as he built sound. Mr. Speaker, this is personal for me. I played under Dr. Fears' direction in our church orchestra. I experienced his precision, his patience, and his assistance that what we offered, whether sacred or civic, had to be excellent.

[00:50:22] And he taught us that music is not just performance. It is leadership, discipline, and legacy. And under his leadership, the Spartan Legion became a cultural ambassador and gave Norfolk State its enduring spirit call.

[00:50:39] Behold, the green and gold that called has echoed far beyond Norfolk, from the Rose Bowl parade to Virginia's inauguration parade. And though Dr. Fears passed away in 2023 at the age of 97, his legacy is still marching across this Commonwealth and across this nation and through the lives of the students he shaped.

[00:51:09] So today, during Black History Month and on NSU Day at the Capitol, we honor Dr. Emory L. Fears, a builder of people, a keeper of standards, and a faithful steward of black excellence.

[00:51:27] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Mayda.

[00:51:45] Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As we celebrate Black History Month, I want to honor the living legacy of a Chesterfield County resident and a personal hero of mine, Chief Justice Cleo Elaine Powell.

[00:52:04] Justice Powell received both her undergraduate and law degrees from the University of Virginia. After working at a large law firm, she began her public service career in the office of the Virginia Attorney General. After re-entering the private sector again, she returned to public service as a judge.

[00:52:24] She would go on, Mr. Speaker, to serve at every level of Virginia's judicial system. She began her term as the Chief Justice of the Virginia Supreme Court this year. She is only the second woman and the first African-American woman to serve as Chief Justice.

[00:52:43] But she means so much more to me personally. After graduating from Howard Law, my first job was as then Judge Powell's law clerk in 2002 when she served on the circuit court. I had a front row seat

to excellence.

[00:53:02] I saw how she carefully considered cases, how she treated litigants with respect, and made everyone feel heard whether she ruled for them or not. She didn't hammer into me how a judge should act. She showed me, Mr. Speaker, and all of us through her demeanor, her poise, and her attention to detail.

[00:53:27] Mr. Speaker, as we celebrate Black History Month, I selected Justice Powell not only because of all of the many barriers she has broken time and time again, but also because in doing so, she has carried so many of us along with her.

[00:53:43] I dare say, Mr. Speaker, that there are hundreds of Leslie Mehta's in and around Virginia who are better off for having known her. I continue to admire her as a lawyer, jurist, working mom and personal mentor.

[00:54:02] I bear witness to the many times she has balanced all of these. She brings alive Black history because she is a living example of what is possible when brilliance, preparation, and character meet opportunity.

[00:54:21] Mr. Speaker, representation is not just about visibility. It's also about possibility. As a young woman from a small town in North Carolina, I cannot adequately express what it feels like seeing someone from small Brunswick County, Virginia, navigating spaces that were not built for them and doing so with excellence and grace.

[00:54:50] She didn't have to tell me. She showed me that I belong even when history told me otherwise. Mr. Speaker, I submit to you and the members of this esteemed body that the next time you witness Justice Powell on the bench or see her return to this floor, notice that her mere presence shows that excellence is not optional, integrity is not negotiable, and leadership is as much about how you treat people as the decisions you make.

[00:55:26] So, Mr. Speaker, during this Black History Month, I am so proud to honor someone who has paved the way for me personally and for so many others, Justice Cleo Powell, a true Chesterfield trailblazer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:55:51] The delegate from Powhatan, Delegate Ware. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. May we return to the first morning hour for an introduction? Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I've been inspired by my colleague from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. I'm not going to cite any Roman classicist or metaphysical poet from England, but a little more homely quote from an American.

[00:56:20] an essayist and naturalist henry david thoreau once said i have traveled a good deal in concord and everywhere in shops offices and fields and the folks who are visiting us today and i would ask the powhatan leadership institute to stand if they are in the gallery which i'm told that they are for over 20 years the folks at the powhatan leadership institute have traveled a good deal in powhatan and they've done it to see county government in action the various services that are there, natural and historic resources, local businesses and civics groups, and they've been

[00:56:57] here today in the Capitol. Mr. Speaker, we've had a lively exchange about the practices and some of the policies and doings of the General Assembly of 2026. It was an interesting conversation, and I would ask members of the House to join me in giving the students of the Powhatan Leadership Institute a

warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today, and you win best cowboy hat in the gallery of all time. The delegate from Enrico, Delegate LaVere Bowling.

[00:57:37] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise to request that we return to the first morning hour for the purposes of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery we are joined by a group of dedicated advocates from the Alzheimer's Association and I ask that they please stand to be recognized. The Alzheimer's Association is the leading voluntary health organization in the fight against Alzheimer's disease and other dementias. Their volunteers include caregivers, individuals living with dementia, healthcare professionals, and community members who are working every day to support families and strengthen dementia care in our

[00:58:11] commonwealth. In Virginia alone, the number of people aged 65 and older with Alzheimer's is 164,000. That is 11.7 percent of the 65 and older population. There are more than 346,000 unpaid caregivers in Virginia. Of those 364,000, 64% have chronic health conditions, 31% do so while battling depression, and 15% of caregivers are already in poor physical health. They are here today to share their perspectives and to help ensure that the voices of those affected by

[00:58:46] Alzheimer's are heard and seen. I appreciate their willingness to take time to be here and to advocate on behalf of so many Virginians, and Mr. Speaker, I ask that my colleagues of the House please join me and giving them a warm House welcome. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. Clerk will call the calendar. Calendar for today, Tuesday, February 10th, 2026 for the Virginia House of Delegates.

[00:59:17] First category, about 118 pieces of legislation, give or take, to be processed today. First category, House Bill's on third reading, uncontested calendar. 30 bills-ish in the block, spread across pages 1 through 12 if you're following that way. House Bill 22 is out of the block. Continuing Continuing with the block House Bills 100, 191, 224, 237, 390, 402, 443, 448, 520, 543, 567.

[00:59:45] House Bills 581, 645, 647, 706, 714, 759, 768 over on page 8. Continuing with third reading uncontested calendar block House Bill 846, 872, 910, House Bill 929, House Bill 958 is out of the block, over to the regular calendar, continuing with the block, House Bill 1020, as well as House Bill 1081, 1108, 1119, 1180, 1341, 1350, and rounding out third reading, final passage, uncontested calendar block, top of page 12, House Bill 1358, and finally House Bill 1381.

[01:00:24] Shall the bills pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 98, no zero. Ayes 98, no zero. The bills pass.

[01:00:42] Continuing with today's calendar, new category, House Bill's third reading, final passage, regular calendar. 40-plus bills in this category, top of page 13, beginning with House Bill 365, which relates to emergency vehicles exempt from certain traffic regulations.

[01:00:59] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 96, noes, 2.

[01:01:15] Ayes, 96, noes, 2. The bill passes. House Bill 43 relates to abolishing the common law crime of suicide. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:01:34] Ayes. 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, noes 35. The bill passes. Ayes Bill 70, now before you, relates to resilient Virginia revolving fund projects, low-income geographic areas, and nature-based solutions. Shall the bill pass?

[01:01:55] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 82, noes 16. Ayes 82, noes 16. The bill passes. House Bill 112, now before you, relates to the Department of Wildlife Resources, premature separation and hybridization of

mammalian wildlife prohibited exceptions.

[01:02:18] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 71, noes 27. Ayes 71, noes 27, the bill passes.

[01:02:34] House Bill 129 relates to killing of deer, damaging residential plants and certain property. Shall the bill pass? Killing bandits, killing bandits. Clerk will close the roll.

[01:02:53] Ayes 87, excuse me, ayes 88, noes 9. Ayes 88, Nose 9, the bill passes. House Bill. Pew, pew, pew, pew, pew, pew, pew. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, House Bill 167, now before you, relates to tax exemptions, confederacy organizations.

[01:03:17] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, Nose 35. Ayes 62, Nose 35, the bill passes.

[01:03:34] House Bill 172 relates to criminal cases, request for a jury to ascertain punishment. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:03:51] Ayes 63, noes 34. Ayes 63, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 290 relates to false statements as to school division or attendance zone residency. Penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:04:14] Ayes 81, noes 17. Ayes 81, noes 17. The bill passes. Continuing third reading regular top of page 60 in the printed calendar. House Bill 303 before you relates to divorce, adultery, filing, parties living separate and apart. Shall the bill pass?

[01:04:39] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 67, noes 31. Ayes 67, noes 31, the bill passes. House Bill 322 relates to misbranded meat food products prohibited, civil penalty. Shall the bill pass?

[01:04:57] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, noes 2. Ayes 95, noes 2, the bill passes. House Bill 342 relates to the Virginia, excuse me, the Judicial Inquiry and Review Commission magistrate's availability of complaint forms in courthouses. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close

[01:05:29] the roll. Ayes 63, no's 34. Ayes 63, no's 34. The bill passes. House Bill 355 would require the Department of Education consultation with the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services to develop best practices for annual mental health screenings for public school students in grades 6 through 12 utilizing evidence-based tools. School Health Service Committee study report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 64, no's

[01:06:04] 33. Ayes 64, noes 33. The bill passes. House Bill 357 relates to release of accused on secured or unsecured bond. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35.

[01:06:30] The bill passes. House Bill 462 would directly, the Board of Education, require health literacy instruction in grades 9 and 10 in the next regularly scheduled revision of the health education standards of learning. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 64, noes 34.

[01:06:57] Ayes 64, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 468 relates to the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia guidelines for developing a transition IEP report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 87, noes 10. Ayes 87, noes 10. The bill passes. House Bill 556 relates to divorce decrees, reports of divorce, social security numbers, or other control numbers. Shall the bill

[01:07:34] pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 86, noes 11. Ayes 86, noes 11, the bill passes. Ayes 557 relates to tangible personal property tax, electric landscaping equipment. Shall the bill pass?

[01:08:03] The clerk will close the row. Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35, the bill passes. Ayes 595 relates to the Board of Education, requirements for graduation with an Advanced Studies Diploma, simultaneous completion of an International Baccalaureate Diploma and Advanced Studies Diploma, approval of alternatives for certain credit requirements.

[01:08:27] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes 94, noes 3. Ayes 94, noes 3, the bill passes.

[01:08:42] House Bill 601 relates to exemptions from garnishment, minimum protected account balance, certain benefit payments, procedure for financial institutions. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:09:04] Ayes 92, noes 6. Ayes 92, noes 6. The bill passed. Ayes Bill 667 relates to juvenile and domestic relation district court jurisdiction definitions petitioned by non-citizen aged 8 to 21 years for legal custody.

[01:09:24] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 64, noes 34. Ayes 64, noes 34.

[01:09:40] The bill passed. Over on page 20, we continue third reading on regular. House Bill 705 would require the Board of Education to include a program of instruction on water safety in its next regularly scheduled revision of the Health Education Standards of Learning and Curriculum Framework. Shall the bill pass?

[01:09:58] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 82, noes 16. Ayes 82, noes 16. The bill passes. House Bill 749 relates to fertilizer and lime permit requirements.

[01:10:17] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 97, noes 0. Ayes 97, noes 0. The bill passes.

[01:10:32] House Bill 905 relates to persons other than ministers who may perform rights of marriage. Clerk, issuance of order, bond requirement. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:10:52] Ayes 75, noes 22. Ayes 75, noes 22. The bill passes. House Bill 915 relates to local taxation extension for federal government shutdown. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate McNamara. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill.

[01:11:09] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So House Bill 915 illustrates the significant and profound differences between the way one side of the aisle looks at affordability and the way the Republicans look at affordability.

[01:11:25] So one side of the aisle looks at affordability in House Bill 915, where we take a specific class of citizen, one group of citizens, and we say other citizens in your locality, if they can't pay their personal property tax, most commonly a car tax, then other citizens can pay theirs on time and carry the locality until it's convenient for this one particular group, government employees, to pay their car tax.

[01:11:58] tax. This side of the aisle would do things a little differently and say, let's just eliminate the car tax. Mr. Speaker, I look forward to having that bill on the floor, and I would encourage us to broaden House Bill 905 to include all people and all localities for all car tax. Thank you,

[01:12:19] Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Excuse me. Ayes 68, nos 30. Ayes 68, knows 30. The bill passes. House Bill 924 relates to the Board of Education and Superintendent of Public Instruction State Program to support the improvement of low-performing schools.

[01:12:52] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 88, knows 10. Ayes 88, knows 10. The bill passes. House Bill 933 relates to penalties for failure to appear contempt. Shall the bill pass?

[01:13:21] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, knows 35. Ayes 62, knows 35. The bill passes. House Bill 942, Now, before he relates to child abuse, neglect, custody, and visitation, possession, or consumption of authorized substances.

[01:13:39] Shall the bill pass?

[01:13:49] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. Ayes 62, noes 36. Ayes 62, noes 36. The bill passes. Ayes bill 950, relates to use of unmanned aircraft systems for public bodies, search warrant required, exception. Shall the bill pass?

[01:14:09] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1013 relates to the Marine Resources Commission, Chesapeake Bay, Diamondback, Terebin protection areas, use of bycatch reduction devices on crab traps penalty.

[01:14:29] Shall the bill pass? Triple close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35.

[01:14:45] Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 1071 relates to public elementary and secondary schools and institutions of higher education, threat assessment teams, training on emergency substantial risk orders and substantial risk orders. Shall the bill pass?

[01:15:06] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 65, Ayes 64, Noes 32. Ayes 64, Noes 32. The bill passes. House Bill 1100 relates to wage garnishment, treasurer's liens for unpaid taxes and charges.

[01:15:25] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 85, Noes 13.

[01:15:40] Ayes 85, Noes 13. The bill passes. House Bill 1110 relates to the Marine Products Board, Blue Catfish, Chesapeake Wild Harvest Certification. shall the bill pass clerk will close the roll ayes 93 noes 4 ayes 93 noes 4 the bill passes over on page 24 we come to house bill 1165 which would require the board of education to amend its regulations relating to the qualifications of division superintendents

[01:16:17] shall the bill pass clerk will close the roll ayes 61 noes 35 ayes 61 noes 35 the bill passes bill 1437 relates to teacher other instructional personnel and support staff position exits, data collection, disaggregation

[01:16:42] by race. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, noes 35, the bill pass. House Bill 1486 relate to public schools, student instruction, addictive potential of time

[01:17:04] spent using certain electronic devices. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 94, noes 4.

[01:17:23] Eyes 94, Nose 4, the bill passes. House Bill 1499 relates to the Department of Education policies relating to instructional material that contains sexually explicit content, applicability, construction. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:17:48] Eyes 62, Nose 35. Eyes 62, Nose 35, the bill passes. House Bill 29, legislation to amend and reenact Chapter 725 of the Acts of the Assembly of 2025, which appropriates the public revenue, Two years ending respectively on June 30, 2025 and June 30, 2026, as well as a bill to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia.

[01:18:10] The delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Tata. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking of the bill. The delegate on the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I actually am specifically speaking to the Congressional

District Amendment in this bill. Mr. Speaker, historian and politician Lord Acton famously warned us that power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely.

[01:18:32] It's a stark reminder that unchecked authority inevitably leads to moral and political decay. History proves that as power increases, the temptation to act in self-interest grows until the abuse of that power becomes almost certain.

[01:18:47] Mr. Speaker, I fear our beloved Commonwealth is being steered toward a future where one party rules with absolute, unchallenged power. The push to amend Virginia's constitution to allow mid-decade redistricting is driven by a single motivation, to cement partisan control of Virginia for a generation, if not forever. The objective here isn't fairness. It's a calculated effort to consolidate power.

[01:19:13] By moving from a balanced map to one designed to silence the opposition, this body is disenfranchising nearly half of Virginia's voters. The majority is telling millions of Virginians that their voices no longer matter. Mr. Speaker, I've been in this body for a while, and I don't often talk about my family's roots, but they run deep into the heart of Virginia, spanning several generations going all the way back to the very first families in Virginia, from the mountains of Patrick County to the valleys of Russell and the shores of Virginia Beach.

[01:19:45] As a matter of fact, I'm a direct descendant of Elizabeth Henry, Patrick Henry's sister. This history reminds me that concern about the government's silencing its citizens is not new. Speaking of Patrick Henry, in 1788, in this very city, while serving as the first governor of Virginia, he addressed the Richmond Convention.

[01:20:06] He warned against a government that grows too strong and too indifferent to the natural rights of its citizens, rights bestowed by God. Today, 238 years later, Patrick Henry's warnings remains as poignant as ever. Every voter deserves an equal voice in this government, regardless of zip code.

[01:20:24] Mr. Speaker, we've heard the justifications. We've heard about political maneuvers in other states, but Patrick Henry had an answer for that logic, too. The eternal difference between right and wrong does not fluctuate. It is immutable.

[01:20:40] Right and wrong do not change based on which party holds the gavel. Less than five years ago, the people of Virginia spoke. They overwhelmingly approved a constitutional amendment to put redistricting into the hands of a bipartisan commission. At the time, it was supported by both sides of the aisle in the General Assembly.

[01:20:59] our governor, who was a vocal opponent of gerrymandering then, threw her support behind that amendment. So, Mr. Speaker, I ask, what has changed to warrant such an abandonment of fairness? The answer is simple. The only thing that has changed is the party that holds the power. Thank

[01:21:15] you. Shall the bill pass? Triple close the row. Ayes, 63, noes, 35. Ayes, 63, noes, 35. The bill passes. House Bill 109 relates to the Board of Agriculture and Consumer Services, Noxious

[01:21:50] Weed's commercial viability. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 96, noes 2. Ayes 96, noes 2. The bill passes. Over on page 26 we come to House Bill 459 relating to crime victims' rights to non-disclosure of certain information, hate crimes. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the

[01:22:30] roll. Ayes 93, noes 4. Ayes 93, noes 4. The bill passes. House Bill 1485 relates to the maximum number of judges on the Court of Appeals of Virginia, hearings on summary disposition of certain civil

cases. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 84, noes 14. Ayes 84, noes 14. The bill passes. House Bill 710 relates to the Board of Agriculture and Consumer Services

[01:23:09] Invasive Plant Species Installation, written notification to property owners, civil penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, noes 2. Ayes 95, noes 2, the bill passes.

[01:23:34] And picking up two other bills before, over on page 1 of the printed calendar, House Bill 22 relates to public institutions of higher education, disciplinary immunity for certain individuals who make reports, Virginia Military Institute. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close

[01:24:08] the roll. Ayes 94, noes 3. Ayes 94, noes 3. The bill passes. And on page 9, we pick up House Bill 958, last bill in this block. House Bill 958 relates to corporate income tax, taxable income, net operating loss. Shall the bill pass? Cook will close the roll. Ayes 95, noes 1, abstentions 1.

[01:24:43] I'm sorry, Ayes 96, noes 1, abstentions 1. Ayes 96, noes 1, abstentions 1. The bill passes. Mr. Speaker, continuing with today's calendar, new category, House Bills on second reading, uncontested, uncontested second reading, about two dozen bills in this category.

[01:25:03] Top of page 27, we're following along in the printed calendar. We begin with House Bill 701, which is now before. It seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to health insurance, notice of adverse determination, and right to request external review. Legislation report, Committee for Labor and Commerce with amendment nature substitute.

[01:25:18] The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendment, the substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:25:34] Mr. Speaker, HB 701 strengthens transparency in timelines and health insurance coverage decisions and requires health insurance carriers to provide written notice of an adverse or final adverse determination within five business days, along with clear information about a patient's right to request an external review.

[01:25:52] It also ensures notices include a unique identifier for the provider coverage who made the coverage decision, Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Thank you. Next up in the block is House Bill 756, legislation amended and reenacted sections of the Code of Virginia relating to amending death certificates, petitions to the court to amend service upon state and registrar of vital records.

[01:26:15] Legislation reporting on health and human services, amendment 8 for substitute. The delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, I move the House adopt the committee substitute? Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. Sustitutes agree to. Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, House Bill 756 further modernizes death care using the electronic death registration system by allowing a more efficient method of amending death certificates as necessary. Madam Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed in Pasteur's third reading. House Bill 813 now before you would amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to health insurance, application of cost

[01:26:52] sharing prohibitions legislation work video on labor and commerce the delegate from fairfax delegate sullivan thank you madam speaker madam speaker hba 13 brings virginia code in line with

federal statute regarding high deductible health plans and protects consumers who use them i hope it'll be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass on to its third read house bill 815 now before you seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of the code of virginia are related to the virginia health workforce development authority administration of nursing scholarships This legislation is reported committee on health and human services.

[01:27:24] The delegate from York, Delegate Downey. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 815 is a nursing workforce bill developed as a collaboration between Virginia Health Workforce Development Authority and the Virginia Department of Health. This legislation accomplishes four goals. It establishes the Virginia Nursing Workforce Center to help ensure an adequate qualified nursing workforce statewide.

[01:27:44] It shifts the authority for specified nursing scholarship and loan repayment programs from the Virginia Department of Health to Virginia Health Workforce Department of Health. It directs the authority to establish an annual reporting schedule requiring submission of health workforce data. It allows the authority to evaluate health workforce programs administered or supported by the Commonwealth.

[01:28:02] I hope it is the will of the body engrossed the bill and passed it on to its third reading. Continuing with the uncontested block, House Bill 893. As legislation has been re-enacted sections of the Code of Virginia Land Electric Utility Integrated Resources Planning, Energy Storage Resources Power Flow Model, Legislation Board Committee on Labor and Commerce, Amendment Nature Substitute.

[01:28:22] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Madam Speaker, I move the substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, HB893 requires that an integrated resource plan conducted by a Virginia utility assess the use of energy storage resources through appropriate modeling that accounts for economic charge and discharge times and represents various economic scenarios.

[01:28:46] I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. House Bill 898 is out of the block. Therefore, continuing with the block, top of page 29, the printed counter, House Bill 902, seeks to amend and reenact the code of Virginia relating to financial institutions out of state credit unions. Legislation report committee on labor and commerce.

[01:29:03] delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Current law requires that the National Credit Union Administration designate an agent for service of process for out-of-state credit unions operating and merging in Virginia. In practice, the required registration form has not always been completed by NCUA, which has led to avoidable delays for credit unions seeking to complete mergers and do business in Virginia. This bill is a cleanup bill that clarifies the code and ensures administrative issues don't slow down the ability of credit unions to do business in Virginia. I'm moving to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up in the blog, House Bill 921.

[01:29:35] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact sections of the code of Virginia relating to electric utilities, licensed retail suppliers, renewable portfolios, standard requirements. Legislation report, Committee on Labor and Commerce, with the nature of substitute. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to?

[01:29:51] All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. This bill reduces the return to utility notice from five years to 18 months, allowing Virginia closer, aligning Virginia closer to PJM and national standards. This is a balanced pro-business

update that encourages competition where it allowed and keeps Virginia businesses attractive for investment.

[01:30:12] Supported by Dominion, Shell Oil, and the environmental community, I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up, we come to House Bill 1007, which seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Birth-Related Neurological Injury Compensation Program and Fund.

[01:30:30] Board of Directors, Plan of Operation, Filing of Claims, Awards and Coverage for Expenses or Services. This legislation is reported on Labor and Commerce with amendments. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran. Thank you so much, Madam Speaker. I would like to move the committee amendments.

[01:30:47] Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendments are agreed to. Delegate Tran. Thank you. Madam Speaker, this bill modernizes the Virginia Birth-Related Neurological Injury Compensation Program, also known as the Birth Injury Fund. It authorizes electronic filing, establishes clear deadlines, removes language inconsistent with federal law, and codifies essential benefits that are being provided under the program, and it also strengthens oversight and transparency of the program while preserving its original purpose and long-term financial stability.

[01:31:19] I hope it's will to body to engross this bill and pass it to its third reading. Turning to page 30 of the printed calendar, if you're following that way, House Bill 1062, of the block over to the regular calendar therefore continuing with the block top of page 31 House Bill 10 1086 this legislation to amend and reenact sections of the code of Virginia as well as amend portions of the acts of assembly of 2024 related to Virginia Public Procurement Act preference for Virginia goods school nutrition programs sunset extension legislation for committee on general laws the delegate from Auburn Morrow delegate Laffer thank you madam speaker HB 110 is a bill to equip local school

[01:31:55] nutrition programs with the ability to provide Virginia food for Virginia kids. It adds a Virginia farm-to-school exemption to encourage the purchase of Virginia-produced or processed agricultural products. And Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Next up in the block, House Bill 1097. This is legislation to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to driver communication improvement program from drivers diagnosed with autism spectrum disorder, education for law enforcement officers and emergency medical service providers, educational materials for public schools.

[01:32:29] Legislation Report Committee on Transportation with amendments. The delegate from Arbor Morrow, Delegate Lauffer. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, I move the House adopt the committee amendments. Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendments are agreed to.

[01:32:45] Delegate Lauffer. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 1097 is a recommendation from the Disability Commission. to address gaps in the Blue Envelope Program. It requires the DMV to provide information on the Blue Envelope Program and driver training schools. Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:33:04] Continuing with the block, House Bill 1145 is legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia relating to motor vehicle safety inspections frequency. Legislation report to the Committee on Transportation with Amendment 8, Substitute. The Delegate from Bonitat, Delegate Austin. Thank you, Madam Speaker.

[01:33:19] Madam Speaker, I move the committee to substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate Austin. Madam Speaker, HB 1145 creates a certified state inspector's position to perform motor vehicle safety inspections.

[01:33:36] Over the years, many constituents have reached out to share their frustration with how difficult it can be to schedule a vehicle inspection in a timely manner. A major contributor to this problem is a shortage of auto mechanics who are qualified to perform these inspections. This new position will be certified by the superintendent of state police and will address this issue without sacrificing safety.

[01:33:57] I move the bill to be engrossed to move to the third reading. House Bill 1157 seeks to amend and reenact sections go to Virginia relating to charitable gaming, denial, suspension, or revocation of permit. Legislation report committee on general laws. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Kruzik.

[01:34:13] Thank you, Madam Speaker, members of the body. This bill is an agency bill that removes duplicative language in the current Charitable Gaming Code because current law is unclear on whether VDACs can combine two administrative processes into a single process to satisfy both requirements, thus creating a burden for the agency.

[01:34:32] I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up is House Bill 1191, which seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to Utility Consumer Services Cooperatives of substation construction. Legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce with amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin.

[01:34:49] Thank you, Madam Speaker. I would move adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agreed to. Delegate Shin. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1191 allows large customers of electric cooperatives defined as those with demand exceeding 20 megawatts requiring high voltage interconnection to be able to self-fund and self-construct their own dedicated substations.

[01:35:12] All construction, operation, and maintenance costs are borne solely by the customer, and no costs are passed on to other rate payers. These agreements would be overseen by the State Corporation Commission. Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be encrosed and passed its third reading. House Bill 1214, now before you seek to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia relating to health insurance, cost-sharing payments for insulin and diabetes equipment and supplies, limit.

[01:35:37] Legislation report, Committee on Labor and Commerce. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Members of the House, House Bill 1214 decreases the cap on covered prescription insulin and equipment and supplies from $50 to $35 to make it more affordable for everyday Virginians by lowering the cap on insulin.

[01:35:56] And now supplies and equipment, hundreds of thousands of diabetics in Virginia can better prioritize their futures and not worry as much about financing medical bills. So I hope it is the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and move it forward. House Bill 1225 is out of the block, therefore continuing with the block.

[01:36:13] Next bill in it is House Bill 1226. This is legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Motor Vehicles data, certain institutions of higher education fees. Legislation report to the Committee on Transportation. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell.

[01:36:29] Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, House Bill 1226 authorizes institutions of higher education with the main campus located in the Commonwealth of Virginia to request the contact information of individuals who purchased their institution's special license plate and have provided consent.

[01:36:45] Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass its third reading. Continuing with the block, House Bill 1288, which is legislation to amend and reenact the Section Code of Virginia related to enforcement of vehicle liens, property value, legislation report from the Committee on Transportation. The delegate from Winchester, Delegate Wiley.

[01:37:01] Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1288 makes updates to the code, which will limit the number of court filings needed to sell abandoned vehicles but updates the vehicle value cap. This cap has not been updated in a decade, and this legislation merely brings the numbers in line with inflation.

[01:37:17] I hope it's the will of the body to have this bill engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 1290. This is legislation to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia-related commercial motor vehicles definition. This legislation also is reported on transportation.

[01:37:32] The delegate from Winchester, Delegate Wiley. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1290 updates the Code of Virginia's definition of a commercial motor vehicle to incorporate not only the gross vehicle weight rating of a towed vehicle, but also its actual gross weight using whichever value is greater. This modernization eliminates a longstanding technical mismatch with federal and strengthens Virginia's enforcement posture. I hope it's the will of the body to have this bill engrossed and passed on to its third reading.

[01:37:58] House Bill 1336 says legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia landed a definition of three-unit service dog team. Required entry to public spaces. Legislation reporting committee on health and human services would amendment nature of substitute. The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Fowler.

[01:38:14] Thank you, Madam Chairman. Health Bill 1336 clarifies the definition of a three-unit service dog team that a person who is an adult and who has been trained to handle the service dog can include the parent of such person with a disability.

[01:38:33] The bill also provides that three-unit service dog teams shall be permitted entry into all public places of public accommodation pursuant to relevant law, unless expressly forbidden, pursuant to a valid court order. Madam Chairman, I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to his third reading.

[01:38:51] Questions on committee sessitutes? Shall the sessitutes be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The sessitutes agree to. House Bill 1343 is legislation amended and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to alcoholic beverage control, banquet license, municipality, or nonprofit organization, Legislative Committee on General Laws.

[01:39:12] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Belova. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 1343 allows a museum to deactivate a retail license in their museum store in order to hold a banquet license and allow for support from manufacturers, importers, wholesalers for a special event.

[01:39:31] Currently, one cannot hold this type of license, banquet license, if the museum sells alcohol in the museum store. I hope it is the pleasure of this body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Thank you. Continuing with the block, House Bill 1347 is legislation directing the Board of Pharmacy to promulgate regulations that allow for the prescribing, possessing, and dispensing and use of psilocybin.

[01:39:57] Legislation was reported to the Committee on Health and Human Services. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 1347 removes a state-level delay that can prevent Virginians from accessing newly FDA-approved medical treatments.

[01:40:13] This bill will provide help to those with serious conditions like treatment-resistant depression and PTSD by ensuring FDA-approved psilocybin moves from Schedule 1 into a lower schedule here in Virginia as soon as the DEA takes action on the federal level.

[01:40:29] I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 1353, which would direct the Commissioner of Health to convene a multidisciplinary work group to evaluate the feasibility of a statewide maternal health safety initiative.

[01:40:45] Reports, legislation reporting on health and human services with an amendment. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I'd first ask that we move the amendment. Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The amendment is agreed to. Delegate Cohen.

[01:41:01] Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 1353, as amended, asked the Commissioner of Health to convene a multidisciplinary workgroup to evaluate the feasibility of a statewide maternal health safety initiative to improve antepartum and postpartum outcomes through patient education, wristband identification, or similar initiatives, clinical alerts, and community engagement. I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:41:27] Shall the bills be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Ms. Speaker, that completes that section of the calendar. We move to a new category, House Bill's on second reading, regular 20-ish bills in this category. Page 37, if you're following that way, House Bill 1161 and 524 are by for the day.

[01:41:47] Therefore, the first bill in this new category is House Bill 1095, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia, Plain to high school students completion of certain applications for student financial aid required. Opt out exemption. Legislation report committee on education with amendments.

[01:42:04] And Mr. Speaker, the bill's patron, has a floor substitute. Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendments and ask the body to vote no. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendments are not agreed to.

[01:42:22] Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I move the floor substitute. Clerk will report the floor substitute. Mr. Speaker, a floor substitute offered by Delegate Singh is available online

to the members of IHOD, to the public on the legislative information system that is now before the body. Mr. Speaker, this is a college affordability bill, the National College Attainment.

[01:42:40] Is this what the floor substitute does? You want to speak to the floor substitute and move it? Mr. Speaker, speaking to the floor substitute. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, this is a college affordability bill. The National College Attainment Network, NCAN, estimates that we're leaving $85 million in Pell Grants on the table. This bill would increase the completion rate of the free application for federal student aid, FAFSA, which is used to access Pell Grants for community colleges, skilled trade training, and four-year colleges.

[01:43:04] Other states such as Alabama, Illinois, and Texas have adopted such policies and have seen impressive results. Data indicates that Virginia students could unlock $17 million in Pell Grants. Mr. Speaker, I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the floor substitute be agreed to?

[01:43:21] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor substitute is agreed to. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 38, we come to House Bill 190, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to financial institutions' prevention of continuation of known fraudulent transactions or occurrences.

[01:43:44] Legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce with an amendment of nature to substitute. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Commerce Fowler. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. First, I'd like to move the substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:44:00] HB 190 directs the Office of the Attorney General to convene a work group to review industry best practices for prevention and response to scams and fraud in financial institutions in an effort to address an ongoing issue that has affected people across the Commonwealth.

[01:44:15] They are being taken advantage of, Mr. Speaker, and it falls upon us to act on that, deliver change, and protect our constituents. Mr. Speaker, I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:44:32] House Bill 300 now before you seeks to amend the Code of Virginia-related expiration of cooperative agreements, period of oversight by the Attorney General, transfer of records. Legislation will support a committee on health and human services. Amendment nature, substitute. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee, substitute.

[01:44:47] Shall the committee, substitute, be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee's substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 300 modernizes Virginia's oversight of cooperative agreements while ensuring safeguards for rural health care and patients. It will be a pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:45:02] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 429 is the legislation to amend and reenact four sections of the Code of Virginia related to electric utilities' integrated resource plans. Legislation report committing on commerce and labor with a substitute.

[01:45:20] The delegate from Henrico, Delegate LaVere Bowling. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, this legislation updates and strengthens how Virginia's electric utilities develop their integrated resource plans, which are the long-term planning documents used to forecast demand and plan how we meet the Commonwealth's future electricity needs.

[01:45:44] The bill improves the planning process by requiring more comprehensive modeling across generation, transmission, and distribution, and directs the utilities to evaluate their grid-enhancing technologies before developing new infrastructure. It also increases transparency and structured public participation.

[01:46:00] I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to his third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed on to his third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed on to his third reading. Next up, we come to House Bill 476. Legislature to amend and reenact the Section of the Code of Virginia relating to care, continuing care providers, quarterly meeting requirements.

[01:46:18] Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce with a substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. For a bit of background, for those who aren't familiar, continuing care residential communities, CCRCs, are for people who are 55 and better, up to the possibility of needing nursing home care.

[01:46:47] They are residential communities, Therefore, they are essentially condominiums. So what the bill before you does is provide that quarterly, rather than just meeting with the employees, there shall be a meeting with the residents with designated representatives of the continuing care ownership, as well as annually a meeting with representatives elected by the residents to discuss financial matters.

[01:47:21] I hope I'm a pleasure of the body to adopt the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. I think, members of the House, next up is House Bill 484, which seeks to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia relating to health insurance, ethics and fairness in carrier business practices, downcoded claims.

[01:47:44] Legislative work committee on labor and commerce from the nature of substitutes. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. thank you mr speaker mr speaker i move adoption of the committee substitute shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye all those opposed no the committee substitute is agreed to thank you mr speaker house bill 484 requires insurance carrier down coding decisions to accurately reflect correct coding standards and consider all relevant patient data it also requires carriers to provide specific reason codes explaining each decision and establishes a clear dispute process including at least 180 days to dispute human review of all disputed

[01:48:18] claims and the ability to dispute claims in a single batch per patient rather than each decision at a time. Mr. Speaker I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. We're on page four and we come to House Bill 508 which is

legislation to amend and reenact section of the code of Virginia relating to small renewable energy projects agrivoltaics definition advisory panel. Legislation reporting Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment to substitute.

[01:48:49] Delegate McAuliffe. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 508 simply defines agrivoltaics as the intentional co-location of agricultural production and solar energy on the same shared land to help preserve that farmland.

[01:49:10] It prioritizes farming activity while integrating renewable energy in a way that preserves that flexibility for farmers. And I hope it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:49:26] House Bill 618 now before you seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia and repeal several others all related to health insurance reporting requirements. Legislation, again, Board of Committee on Labor and Commerce. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:49:42] Mr. Speaker, at the request of the Bureau of Insurance, House Bill 618 modernizes and streamlines the Bureau's data collection and reporting requirements. First, it replaces the mandated benefits report with a publicly maintained inventory. Second, the bill consolidates two balanced billing reports into one single report.

[01:50:00] Third, it eliminates the comparable health care service incentive program report. Fourth, it moves the deadline for the managed care ombudsman report from December 1st to January 1st. And lastly, it eliminates the Virginia Medical Savings Account Plan report, which has not been dually published with the Department of Taxation since 2016, and that would greatly, I think, support the Bureau of Insurance's ability to get this work done.

[01:50:25] Mr. Speaker, I would move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 625, as legislation amend the Code of Virginia relating to health insurance, Limit on cost-sharing payments for prescription drugs under certain plans.

[01:50:44] Legislation reported on labor and commerce with an amendment. The delegate for Mr. Williams, Delegate Henson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 625 requires health insurance carriers and the individual and small group markets to ensure that at least half of their plans they offer, or at least one plan, if fewer than two, are offered at each metal level, comply with the reasonable limits on prescription drug cost-sharing.

[01:51:15] Under the bill, silver, gold, and platinum plans must cap prescription drug cost-sharing at $100 per day, 30-day supply, while bronze plans must cap cost-sharing at $150 per 30-day supply. Mr. Speaker, this bill does have a reenactment clause.

[01:51:31] I move that the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading? All those in favor say aye. Others of the polls, no. The bill is grossed and passed the third reading. Excuse me. Mr. Speaker, coming up next is House Bill 676.

[01:51:49] This is legislation to amend and rein access to the code of Virginia relating to health insurance, care, business practices, electronic attachments. This legislation will work through the Labor and Commerce with an amendment of nature of substitute. Director Prince William, Delegate Mardonato. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to?

[01:52:05] All those in favor say aye. Others of the polls, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 676 is a modernization bill. It allows providers to submit required documentation to insurance carriers through electronic attachments in specific situations, including correcting claim defects and establishing medical necessity, benefit coverage, prior authorizations, or reconsideration of service.

[01:52:28] And second, it also ensures fairness in electronic payments by requiring carriers that impose transactions or processing fees to offer a fee-free electronic payment option. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:52:45] All those in favor say aye. Others opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 770 is legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to public utilities, water, and sewage companies, discounted rates for low-income customers.

[01:53:01] Legislation reporting on Labor and Commerce with an amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee to substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, unlike energy assistance, Virginia does not have a statewide broad-based water affordability program.

[01:53:23] HB 770 creates a targeted solution which will allow utilities the authority and flexibility to respond to community needs and help low-income customers in a structured way. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:53:44] Over on page 42, we come to House Bill 841, which is legislation to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to professions and occupations, definition of practice of athletic training, dry needling, legislation reporting on health and human services with an amendment.

[01:54:01] Delegate from York County, Delegate Downey. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. First, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill, HB 841, as amended, expands the scope of practice for athletic trainers to include dry needling under the direct supervision of a physician.

[01:54:21] The amendment includes an enactment clause which establishes regulation regarding the required training and certification from the Board of Medicine prior to participating in the new scope of practice. In extending this practice to athletic trainers, we increase access and timeliness to treating sports-related injuries with dry needling therapy.

[01:54:38] Mr. Speaker, I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. I thought Garrett already had the license for dry needling. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 892.

[01:54:58] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia-related Electric Utilities Integrated Resource Plan State Corporation Commission to investigate electric load forecasts. Legislation reporting committee on Labor and Commerce with Amendment Nature Substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move adoption of the committee substitute.

[01:55:14] Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 892 directs the SEC to initiate a proceeding to review load forecasting practices by electric utilities, including distribution cooperatives.

[01:55:31] As part of this proceeding, the SEC will have an opportunity to scrutinize the methodologies, the data, and the assumptions, as well as the accuracy of the forecasts. They'll also be able to review the forecast the utilities are submitting to PJM, determine whether the utilities are incorporating appropriate risk minimization terms into the load forecast and require anonymized data sets that would help to replicate load forecast results and identify potentially duplicative load data.

[01:55:55] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 975 is by for the day. Therefore, we come next to House Bill 1166. Legislation amending to reenact Section of the Code of Virginia related to financial institutions, check cashers, expiration of registration.

[01:56:16] Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce. Delegate from Stafford, Delegate Carol. Yes, Mr. Speaker. I stand before you, HB 1166 just simply establishes an automatic expiration date on check cashing registrations for failure to pay the required annual fee.

[01:56:35] Mr. Speaker, we know that the SEC is in agreeance to this, and they fully support the fact that this one administrative change could increase their staff efficiency by 5%, saving over 100 staff hours annually. Mr. Speaker, making this administrative change aligns the check cashing registration with the existing statutory models used for other financial services provided here in Virginia.

[01:56:59] Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. House Bill 1255, now before you six to amend and reenact, Texas Code of Virginia relating to net energy metering, standby charge, facility capacity.

[01:57:18] Legislation Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'd move adoption of the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:57:34] House Bill 1255 lifts the existing cap for solar systems, currently for residential solar systems, rated at 15 kilowatts, and we're changing it to nameplate capacity of 20 kilowatts before the Dominion standby charges go into effect for that residential customer.

[01:57:50] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. Turning to page 44, we come to House Bill 1370, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to the Board of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services, Regulations, Providers of Services for Individuals with Developmental Disabilities, Emergency Medical Drills.

[01:58:13] Legislation Board Committee on Health and Human Services with amendments. Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Mater. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I first move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to.

[01:58:29] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Medical emergencies do not give warnings. They can happen in an instant, and if staff are not prepared, the consequences can be devastating, especially for those with developmental disabilities and others who rely on caretakers. In response, this bill, HB 1370, directs the Board of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services to adopt emergency regulations to better equip staff at these facilities.

[01:58:56] By requiring routine emergency drills, we ensure that when seconds matter most, employees are not guessing, but they are ready to act decisively, Mr. Speaker. I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third ring. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:59:13] All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next, we move to House Bill 1448, legislation to create the Petersburg Parking Authority Act. This legislation committee on transportation. Delegate from Dinwiddie, Delegate Pope Adams.

[01:59:30] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.B. 1448 authorizes the creation of the Petersburg Parking Authority. This bill does not mandate the creation of an authority. It simply authorizes Petersburg to establish one only after a public hearing and approval by their governing body.

[01:59:48] Mr. Speaker, I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Ms. Speaker, picking up the last three bills from this category that were moved from the uncontested to the regular, House Bill 20, excuse me, House Bill 898 on page 28.

[02:00:08] H.B. 898 seeks to amend and reenact the Section of the Code of Virginia relating to electric, gas, water, and wastewater utilities disconnections for non-payment, certain fees prohibited. Legislation reporting on labor and commerce with an amendment of nature substitute. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute.

[02:00:24] Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you Mr. Speaker. HB 898 provides that in a utility's next proceeding for cost recovery and the biannual review the SEC shall determine the maximum allowable for disconnection and reconnection a utility may charge.

[02:00:46] In the proceedings the utility is required to provide written testimony for fees currently assigned to residential customers as related to a disconnection. The SEC will set the maximum allowable fees. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to his third reading.

[02:01:03] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, penultimately, we come to House Bill 1062 on page 30. It seeks to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia related to energy upgrade programs, implementation, capital investment requirements, cost recovery.

[02:01:21] Legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce with a substitute. Delegate for Norfolk, Delegate Hernandez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This is landmark legislation to make energy more affordable for Virginia's families.

[02:01:40] Under this bill, we will be making historic investments in energy efficiency and home energy upgrades over the next couple of years. So in year one, Dominion will invest $23 million, APCO will invest $5 million, with a focus on helping Virginians with low incomes, our seniors, and individuals with disabilities.

[02:02:00] From there, those investments will increase each year, and so over the lifetime of the program, the combined total investment from Dominion and APCO could exceed $300 million, both of whom support this bill. So I move that we engross the bill, pass along to a third reading.

[02:02:16] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. And lastly, we come to page 33 of Delegate Shin's House Bill 1225. Legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to electric utilities, transportation, electrification, electric vehicles, fast charging stations.

[02:02:35] Legislation to agree on labor and commerce with amendments. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would move adoption of the committee's amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. the committee amendment has agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1225 is a bill that we have passed in this body before, and it's a bill to support the development of a reliable and equitable electric vehicle charging infrastructure here in the Commonwealth. The bill does this by in four primary ways. We provide greater certainty to the private market to help them get the electric service when they need it. Second, we narrow down and refine the kinds of transportation

[02:03:11] electrification plans that the utilities are submitting to the SEC under a reasonable and prudent standard. Third, we ensure responsible planning by utilities to meet Virginia's future electric fueling needs, ensuring our electric grid modernizes along with the transportation systems. And finally, the bill directs the SEC to initiate a proceeding to prevent electric utilities from unfairly undercutting private EV charging businesses, primarily today's gas stations so that those private businesses can enter the market without fear of unfair competition.

[02:03:40] Mr. Speaker, I move let the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall this bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All opposed, no. The bill then engrossed and passed the third reading. Sadly, Mr. Speaker, this completes today's calendar. We went out with a bang.

[02:03:57] Per House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No, communications, just simply the meetings, announcements, two of our full committees and various subcommittees of meeting. They are as follows on this Tuesday afternoon. Committee on General Laws will be meeting a half hour after adjournment of the House. House Committee Room B on the second floor of the General Assembly Building, once the full committee is finished, then its ABC Gaming subcommittee will meet.

[02:04:19] Once that subcommittee of General Laws meets, then its subcommittee number five will meet. So that's all on the second floor, House Committee Room B. Also a half hour after German House Committee on Labor and Commerce, they will be down in the lower level, House Committee Room A. Full committee will meet a half hour after German, then subcommittee number one will meet.

[02:04:37] And once subcommittee number one of Labor and Commerce meets, then subcommittee number three will meet. So labor and then two of its subcommittees, just kind of the same way, which under laws, separate rooms, different floors. Four o'clock, we come to Committee on Education, K-12 subcommittee.

[02:04:53] They will be in the House Committee Room C on the second floor. That's at four o'clock today. The Transportation Innovation Subcommittee, they also will be meeting at four, but they will be in the House Subcommittee Room on the second floor. House South Subcommittee for Transportation Innovation, also at four, health and human services health subcommittee uh they'll be up on the 12th floor in the appropriations committee room and the last legislative meeting is uh is the uh committee on finances subcommittee number two uh which is at 4 30 in the house north subcommittee on the second floor of the gab looking ahead to tomorrow week before uh after crossover uh

[02:05:31] before crossover I guess um February 11th 2026 um the first uh gathering with speakers uh interfaith devotional will be up in the speaker's conference room on the 14th floor that's at 7 a.m the conservative energy caucus is meeting at 7 30. uh tomorrow they're in the seventh floor committee uh meeting room there up on the seventh floor um the uh cti's uh innovation subcommittee is not meeting, but at 7:30, ACNR's Natural Resources Subcommittee is meeting.

[02:06:07] They'll be in the House Committee Room B, so Agricultural Chesapeake Natural Resources Natural Resources Subcommittee, and then once they're finished or at 9 o'clock, the full committee will then begin its work on its dock, and that'll all be on the second floor in House Committee Room B. The Military and Veterans Caucus will be meeting at 8 o'clock. They'll will be in the Senate subcommittee room three on the third floor. House Committee on Education will be meeting at 8 o'clock in House Committee Room A in the lower level. That's at 8 o'clock and their subcommittee is not meeting thereafter. At 10 o'clock, the Committee on Appropriations Higher Education

[02:06:45] subcommittee is meeting. That'll be up on the 12th floor in the Appropriations Committee room. Then the Democratic and Republican caucuses are meeting, the Democratic caucus meeting, 1115 tomorrow in House Room 1, 11 o'clock for the Republican caucus in House Room 2 here in the capitol of the Speaker. All the announcements I have, sir. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon.

[02:07:17] As many in favor, the motion to say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Delegate From Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House do now adjourn. It's been in favor of motion to say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.



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